Resampling Cannot See the User: Detecting User-Specific Hallucination in Interactive Agents with Probabilistic Commitments

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Abstract

An agent serving an individual must act on facts about that person it was never told, such as whether a scan is safe today. When it asserts such facts confidently and wrongly, nothing external can check it. We show that sampling-consistency detectors cannot tell users apart within a conversation, and are near chance whenever resamples disagree as often on right as on wrong answers. We propose Probabilistic Game Environments (PGE): the agent states each assumption as a commitment with a confidence, the user's implicit reactions are recorded, and a posterior turns both into per-commitment and per-session risk. In a pre-registered evaluation with five LLM agents, SelfCheck-GPT and semantic entropy score 0.551 and 0.495 AUROC on user-specific hallucination. An intake-aware posterior, added by amendment and run once, reaches 0.825, beats supervised detectors on the same inputs by 0.06–0.09 (they match it only when given its structure), and identifies which commitment is wrong at 0.892 AUROC, where resample disagreement reaches 0.568. Exact Bayes predictors show that the reactions carry information beyond population risk, which agreement between samples ignores. [PENDING: clarification headline] All registered outcomes are reported, including those against our first posterior.

Keywords: LLM agents; hallucination detection; uncertainty; clarification; implicit feedback.

1 Introduction

An agent that schedules imaging appointments must decide whether a patient may have a contrast scan today. The intake form says the patient had a recent treatment, but not when. A careful agent would say it does not know; many instead answer "safe, $p = 0.85$" and proceed. We call this a *user-specific hallucination*: a confident assertion about the current user whose truth depends on something the user never disclosed. It differs from the factual hallucinations that dominate the literature (Ji et al., 2023): there is no document or search engine to check it against.

The leading black-box detectors resample the model and flag answers it does not reproduce (Manakul et al., 2023; Kuhn et al., 2023; Farquhar et al., 2024). That presumes hallucinations are stochastic. Fabricated user facts need not be: an underdetermined question maps the same context to the same guess every time. More fundamentally, two users who share a conversation (the same intake answers and, where the agent is shown them, the same reactions) are indistinguishable to the model, so nothing computed from the model and its context can tell which of them it is wrong about (Theorem 1). Context can still reveal *population* risk, for instance that "no sedation needed" is wrong for a third of patients, and we show that a well-calibrated context-only predictor can exploit it. Sampling-consistency scores of a self-consistent agent do not even do that (Corollary 1).

The way out is to look at the user rather than the model. In PGE the agent must externalize each assumption as a *commitment* $(\text{attribute}, \text{value}, p)$, and the user's reaction (accepting it, contradicting it, or ignoring it) is recorded. Reactions are noisy and partial, but they depend on the truth for *this* user, which no resample does: under a simple model the posterior of the hallucination event uses them exactly (Proposition 1), and less noisy reactions cannot hurt (Theorem 2). Our contributions:

1. **Why resampling fails, and by how much.** No detector computed from the model and its context (resampling, self-verification, hidden-state probes) can tell which of two users sharing a conversation it is wrong about (Theorem 1), and sampling scores are near chance whenever resamples disagree about as often on right as on wrong answers (Corollary 1). On fresh sessions from five agents, all three resamples agree on 50–91% of the commitments whose truth depends on undisclosed facts, resample disagreement predicts their errors at 0.501–0.555 AUROC, and SelfCheck-GPT and semantic entropy score 0.551 and 0.495 on user-specific hallucination.

2. **A protocol that makes these errors detectable.** In PGE the agent states each assumption as a commitment with a confidence and the user's implicit reaction is recorded. Detectors on these observables beat both sampling detectors by +.112 to +.219 AUROC pooled, and the user's reactions add detectable signal beyond population base rates (+.070; significant for 5 of 5 agents).

3. **A posterior that says which claim is wrong.** Our label-event posterior is exact under a conditional-

independence model and identifies its priors from reactions up to one scale parameter (Proposition 2). Its intake-aware form, V7, learns which commitments the intake leaves to the user. Designed on development data after the registered results and registered before its first run, it reaches 0.825 AUROC, beats supervised detectors on the same raw inputs by 0.06–0.09 (registered H8: +.089), and is matched only by a classifier handed its structure. The user's reactions add +.083 to it. Per commitment it identifies the wrong ones at 0.892 AUROC with calibration error 0.077, against 0.568 for resample disagreement; this risk chooses what to ask the user.

4. **Where the information is.** Exact Bayes predictors in a simulator with known truth show that the reactions carry information beyond the population risk of the commitments (+.083 AUROC), and that nearly all of it reaches the agent's transcript: sampling fails not for lack of information, but because agreement between resamples ignores the reactions, and each resample precedes its own commitment's reaction.

5. **A pre-registered evaluation, fully reported.** After a blind internal audit of our development results we fixed a protocol bug, registered every comparison and its wording, and generated fresh sessions with five agents from four families and two domains. We report every registered outcome, including those against our posterior and two simulated patients that failed their quality gate.

2 Related Work

Hallucination detection. Sampling-based detectors measure agreement across resamples (Manakul et al., 2023; Kuhn et al., 2023; Farquhar et al., 2024); semantic entropy is explicitly scoped to stochastic confabulations, not consistent errors (Farquhar et al., 2024). Learned confidence models from a model's generations (Ulmer et al., 2024), white-box probes (Azaria and Mitchell, 2023; Chen et al., 2024; Kossen et al., 2024), and verification by the model's own questions (Dhuliawala et al., 2024) or by search (Wei et al., 2024) are all functions of the model given its context, so Theorem 1 applies to them. Consistent errors are documented in snowballing (Zhang et al., 2024) and self-contradiction studies (Mündler et al., 2024), and calibrated models must hallucinate on facts absent from training (Kalai and Vempala, 2024); our setting is the per-user analogue. Verbalized confidence (Kadavath et al., 2022; Tian et al., 2023; Xiong et al., 2024) is a commitment-level signal we include as a baseline, and iterative prompting can separate epistemic from aleatoric uncertainty (Abbasi Yadkori et al., 2024), still from the model given its context.

Hallucination in agents. MIRAGE-Bench (Zhang et al., 2025) taxonomizes agent actions unfaithful to instructions, history or observations; CAR-bench (Kirmayr et al., 2026) tests whether agents admit missing information with a simulated user; AgentHallu (Liu et al., 2026) localizes the step that introduced an error. In multiagent systems a commitment is a public, checkable obligation of one agent to another (Singh, 1999), and a probabilistic commitment binds an agent to achieve an outcome with a stated probability (Zhang et al., 2016); ours are probabilistic assertions about the counterpart's private state, checked against its reactions. Dialogue models hallucinate about their partner as well as about the world (Dziri et al., 2022). We study detection when the missing information is the user's own.

Clarification. When to ask has been framed through expected value of perfect information (Rao and Daumé III, 2018; Suri et al., 2025), ambiguity detection (Zhang and Choi, 2025), conformal prediction (Ren et al., 2023), and information-gain rewards on τ-bench (Deng et al., 2026; Yao et al., 2024). In clinical dialogue, MediQ (Li et al., 2024) and Uncertainty of Thoughts (Hu et al., 2024) ask a simulated patient questions to reduce the doctor model's uncertainty. These reason about the agent's uncertainty before it acts; we use post-hoc commitment risk to choose which assertions to confirm, and measure the effect with the agent re-reasoning.

Implicit and noisy feedback. Implicit signals such as clicks are informative but biased (Joachims et al., 2005). Conversation partners ground what they assert through the other's acceptance (Clark and Brennan, 1991); spoken dialogue systems confirm hypotheses implicitly and update beliefs from the user's reaction (Bohus and Rudnicky, 2005; Williams and Young, 2007), and chatbots can learn from their partner's satisfaction signals (Hancock et al., 2019); our reactions play the same role for asserted user facts. The general channel of our posterior, with error-dependent contradiction and confirmation rates, has the form of the guess and slip parameters of knowledge tracing (Corbett and Anderson, 1994). Our estimation step inverts a noise channel, as in learning from noisy labels (Angluin and Laird, 1988; Natarajan et al., 2013; Scott et al., 2013) and annotator models (Dawid and Skene, 1979). Agents that revise under user pushback raise sycophancy concerns (Sharma et al., 2024); our simulated user follows a long line of user simulation for dialogue (Schatzmann et al., 2006).

3 Problem, Protocol, and Labels

Definition 1 (User-specific hallucination)**.** *A* commitment *asserts a value v for an attribute a of the current user with confidence* $p \in [0,1]$*. It is* user-dependent *if its true value is not determined by what the user has disclosed, and it is a user-specific hallucination if it is user-dependent, confident (*$p \geq \tau$*), and wrong.*

Protocol. A PGE session has four stages. (i) *Intake*: the user answers a few coarse questions; the agent sees only these answers. (ii) *Commitment*: at each turn the agent emits one commitment in a fixed format, `[attribute]: value, p=confidence`. (iii) *Reaction*: the user's implicit reaction $F_t \in \{-1,0,+1\}$ (contradicts, no reaction, accepts) is recorded and shown to the agent for its next six turns. (iv) *Detection and intervention*: a detector scores the session and its commitments; high-risk commitments trigger a confirmation question.

Labels. With confident set $H = \{t : p_t \geq \tau\}$, $\tau = 0.6$, the *composite* label L (Eq. (1)) marks a session in which at least half of the confident commitments are wrong ($\rho = \frac{1}{2}$), and is 0 if there are none. It mixes two kinds of error. Some attributes are determined by the intake through rules the agent was never shown (e.g. contrast is needed iff urgency is medium or high); errors there are guesses about the clinic, not about the user. The *user-specific* label L_U applies the same rule to the confident commitments that are user-dependent in that session, and is 0 when there are none. Whether a commitment is user-dependent is decided per session by enumerating the hidden profile's support: `scan_safe_now`, for example, depends on days since treatment only when a treatment was recent; `needs_contrast` is fixed by urgency, so a wrong "no" counts in L but never in L_U. L_U is our primary label; L is reported as secondary.

4 What Resampling and Feedback Can Reveal

Setup. A user u is drawn from a population. At turn t the agent conditions on a context X_t: the coarse intake $\phi(u)$, the question, and the interaction history, which in PGE displays earlier reactions; X denotes $(X_1,\ldots,X_T)$. It emits a commitment $c_t = (a_t, v_t, p_t)$ (attribute, value, reported confidence) from its policy $\pi(\cdot \mid X_t)$. Apart from the truth and the reactions, nothing depends on u except through X. The truth $y_a(u)$ is private to the user; the commitment is wrong if $w_t = \mathbf{1}[v_t \neq y_{a_t}(u)]$. With confident set $H = \{t : p_t \geq \tau\}$ and error fraction ρ, a session hallucinates iff

$$L = \mathbf{1}\Big[\,|H| \geq 1 \text{ and } \textstyle\sum_{t\in H} w_t \;\geq\; \lceil \rho\,|H| \rceil\,\Big]. \qquad (1)$$

The results below hold for any binary label determined by (C,u): a single w_t, or L_A, Eq. (1) with H replaced by $H_A = \{t \in H : a_t \in A\}$ for an attribute set A determined by X (for the user-specific label L_U, the attributes the intake does not determine). We write L.

A *context-and-sample detector* is any $S = h(X,C,Z,\xi)$ with ξ independent randomness and Z drawn, given (u,X,C), from a kernel $K(\cdot \mid X,C)$ that does not involve u: resamples at any temperature, token log-probabilities, hidden states. A *feedback detector* also sees reactions $F_t \in \{-1,0,+1\}$ (contradicts, none, accepts). By the Neyman–Pearson (NP) lemma (Neyman and Pearson, 1933), among all, possibly randomized, detectors that are functions of an observation O, thresholding $P(L=1 \mid O)$ (randomized at ties) has the highest true-positive rate at every false-positive rate, hence the highest AUROC; ties count $\frac{1}{2}$. Theorem 1 is the standard data-processing consequence of NP (Neyman and Pearson, 1933; Blackwell, 1953), stated for this setting.

Theorem 1 (Self-consistency bound)**.** *Let $\eta_X = P(L = 1 \mid X,C)$ and S be a context-and-sample detector. Given (X,C), S is independent of u and L, so within a context it ranks hallucinating above clean sessions with probability exactly $\frac{1}{2}$. Across contexts, its ROC curve lies pointwise below that of the Bayes predictor η_X.*

Proof. Given (u,X,C), S depends only on (Z,ξ), whose law does not involve u, and L is a function of (C,u). So the law of S given (X,C) does not depend on L, $P(L=1 \mid X,C,S) = \eta_X$, and NP applies to $O = (X,C,S)$. □

Since X contains the reactions the agent was shown, η_X is not feedback-free, and detectors built from (X,C), such as context-only classifiers, can reflect them and exploit base rates across contexts. Resampling cannot add to (X,C) or separate users who share a context; a feedback detector reads the reactions directly, including the last. For dispersion scores, more is true:

Corollary 1 (Dispersion under systematic fabrication)**.** *Let S be a score of the commitments and their k resamples (agreement rate, semantic entropy, SelfCheck-style inconsistency) that takes a fixed value $s^\star$ whenever every resample equals its commitment, and $e_\ell = P(S \neq s^\star \mid L = \ell)$. Then*

$$\big|\mathrm{AUROC}(S) - \tfrac{1}{2}\big| \;\leq\; \tfrac{1}{2}\big(1-(1-e_0)(1-e_1)\big) \;\leq\; \tfrac{1}{2}(e_0+e_1).$$

If $s^\star$ is the least suspicious value of S, then $\big|\mathrm{AUROC}(S) - \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2}(e_1 - e_0)\big| \leq \frac{1}{2}e_0e_1$. If every turn's resampling distribution is a point mass at the committed value, $\mathrm{AUROC}(S) = \frac{1}{2}$ however often the commitments are wrong.

Proof. For independent positive and negative draws, both scores equal $s^\star$ with probability $(1-e_0)(1-e_1)$; such pairs are ties and contribute exactly $\frac{1}{2}$. All other pairs contribute a value in $[0,1]$. If $s^\star$ is least suspicious, a pair where only the positive (negative) differs from $s^\star$ contributes 1 (0); only pairs where both differ, with probability e_0e_1, are free. □

Table 2 checks the corollary on every agent.

Theorem 2 is Blackwell's garbling theorem (Blackwell, 1953) for a symmetric channel. Let F^ε be feedback generated for the detector: given (u,X,C), which F_t^ε are 0 has a law depending only on (X,C), and each other F_t^ε is $1-2w_t$ with its sign flipped independently with probability ε. Let $\eta_\varepsilon = P(L=1 \mid X,C,F^\varepsilon)$ ($\varepsilon = 0$ is perfect feedback).

Theorem 2 (Less noisy feedback cannot hurt)**.** *Fix the joint law of (u,X,C); in particular, it does not depend on*

ε. *For $0 \le \varepsilon \le \varepsilon' \le \frac{1}{2}$ the ROC curve of η_ε lies pointwise above that of $\eta_{\varepsilon'}$, which lies above that of η_X, and $\eta_{1/2} = \eta_X$ almost surely.*

Proof. If $\varepsilon' = \varepsilon$ there is nothing to show. Otherwise $\varepsilon < \frac{1}{2}$, and flipping each nonzero F_t^ε independently with probability $\delta = (\varepsilon' - \varepsilon)/(1-2\varepsilon) \in [0, \frac{1}{2}]$ yields flip rate $\varepsilon + \delta(1-2\varepsilon) = \varepsilon'$, hence the joint law of $(u, X, C, F^{\varepsilon'})$. So every detector using $F^{\varepsilon'}$ is a randomized detector using F^ε, and NP gives the first inequality; ignoring F gives the second. At $\varepsilon = \frac{1}{2}$, F^ε is independent of u given (X, C): whether a reaction occurs depends only on (X, C), and every observed sign is a fair coin. □

The premise is essential: if the agent conditions on the same reactions, the law of (X, C) changes with ε and monotonicity can fail (a two-turn counterexample is in the repository). The theorem covers reactions regenerated for the detector with the agent's trajectories fixed.

The label-event posterior. Let $\kappa_t = (a_t, v_t, b(p_t))$ be the detector-visible *cell*, where $b(\cdot)$ buckets confidence, and $\mathscr{H}_t = (X_t, c_{1:t}, F_{<t}, w_{<t})$ the history up to the t-th commitment with the earlier errors. (A1) Given $\mathscr{H}_t$, $w_t \sim \text{Bernoulli}(\pi_{\kappa_t})$. (A2) Given $(\mathscr{H}_t, w_t)$, $F_t = 0$ with a probability that depends only on a_t, and otherwise $F_t = 1 - 2w_t$ with its sign flipped with probability ε. Up to a factor free of w_t, the likelihood of F_t is $\ell_{w_t}(F_t)$ with $\ell_w(0) = 1$, $\ell_1(-1) = \ell_0(+1) = 1 - \varepsilon$ and $\ell_1(+1) = \ell_0(-1) = \varepsilon$. (A1) excludes error cascades and intake information beyond the cell, but lets the agent choose cells after seeing feedback.

Proposition 1 (Exact posterior)**.** *Under (A1)–(A2), $P(w_{1:T} \mid X, C, F) = \prod_t q_t^{w_t}(1-q_t)^{1-w_t}$ with $q_t = \pi_{\kappa_t}\ell_1(F_t) / \big(\pi_{\kappa_t}\ell_1(F_t) + (1-\pi_{\kappa_t})\ell_0(F_t)\big)$. Hence $\eta_\varepsilon = P(L = 1 \mid X, C, F)$ is 0 if $H = \varnothing$ and otherwise the Poisson-binomial tail $P\big(\sum_{t\in H} B_t \ge \lceil \rho |H| \rceil\big)$, $B_t \sim \text{Bernoulli}(q_t)$ independent, computable in $O(|H|^2)$. It is Bayes-optimal under (A1)–(A2) with the true priors and channel; the implementation plugs in estimates.*

Proof. Write the joint law in the order $c_1, w_1, F_1, c_2, \ldots$. The policy and the questions see u only through X, so $p(X, C, F, w) = A(X, C, F) \prod_t \pi_{\kappa_t}^{w_t}(1-\pi_{\kappa_t})^{1-w_t}\ell_{w_t}(F_t)$, where A collects the intake prior, the questions, the policy and the w-free factors of (A2). Normalizing over $w \in \{0,1\}^T$ gives independent Bernoulli(q_t). H is fixed by C, L depends on w only through $\sum_{t\in H} w_t$, and NP gives optimality. □

The same proof gives the posterior of L_A (the tail over H_A), and holds for any channel $P(F_t \mid \mathscr{H}_t, w_t) = \ell_{w_t}(F_t)$ that may depend on a_t, as in the general-channel detector. Under (A1) this user's reactions enter only through $\ell_1(F_t)/\ell_0(F_t)$; setting these to 1 leaves the population base rates π_κ (the prior-only ablation). Cascades violate (A1), but a simple cascade model does not help (§7.7).

Proposition 2 (Priors are identified up to one scale)**.** *Assume (A2), let $\pi_\kappa = P(w_t = 1 \mid \kappa_t = \kappa)$, and let $\hat{r}_\kappa$ be the fraction of the n_κ reacted-to commitments in cell κ that were contradicted, with independent errors given n_κ. Then $r_\kappa = \varepsilon + (1-2\varepsilon)\pi_\kappa$; for known $\varepsilon < \frac{1}{2}$, $\hat{\pi}_\kappa = (\hat{r}_\kappa - \varepsilon)/(1-2\varepsilon)$ needs no labels and, with probability at least $1-\delta$, $|\hat{\pi}_\kappa - \pi_\kappa| \le (1-2\varepsilon)^{-1}\sqrt{\log(2/\delta)/(2n_\kappa)}$ (Hoeffding, 1963). Cells that never receive reactions are not identified, and if ε is unknown every $\varepsilon' \le \min_\kappa \min(r_\kappa, 1-r_\kappa)$ fits equally well.*

We fix the scale by training-split label likelihood; unidentified cells get the pooled bucket prior, and estimates are clipped to $[0.01, 0.99]$ and shrunk toward coarser cells.

5 Detectors

PGE yields two observables per turn, a commitment and a reaction. We read them with two kinds of *PGE detectors*: a label-event posterior, which also gives per-commitment risk, and supervised classifiers. The baselines read only the model. Table 1 lists what each one sees.

PGE posterior. The score is a plug-in estimate of the posterior of Proposition 1. Each confident commitment falls in a cell $\kappa = (\text{attribute}, \text{value}, \text{confidence bucket})$ (buckets $[0.6, 0.65)$, $[0.65, 0.75)$, $[0.75, 1]$); cell priors come from training reactions by the method of moments (Proposition 2), shrunk toward attribute- and bucket-level estimates ($k = 5$). The registered primary detector, V6, uses a general channel: contradiction rates $r_w = P(F = -1 \mid w)$ chosen on training labels ($r_1 > r_0 + 0.1$), priors $\pi = (\text{rate} - r_0)/(r_1 - r_0)$, and confirmation rates fit by least squares; V3 is the symmetric special case. For L_U the event is restricted to attributes that depend on a hidden field anywhere in the schema, which the detector can know without the clinic's rules; V6 is therefore the posterior of a proxy event (L_A in Section 4). Whether a commitment is wrong also depends on the intake, which the cell omits, so (A1) fails and the plug-in is misspecified. V6−prior keeps the fitted priors and ignores the test user's reactions.

Intake-aware posterior (V7). V7 repairs both mismatches and nothing else. Its cells add the intake answers each attribute depends on in the schema, shrunk toward V6's cell (errors still share hidden facts across attributes, so (A1) remains an approximation). Its label event is learned: a commitment whose truth the intake fixes is wrong for every user with that intake or for none, a rule error rather than a user-specific one. Starting from the schema-level set, V7 removes an (attribute, intake) cell from the event, or returns it, when that lowers the training log-loss, alternating with the channel fit; for L, whose event is every confident commitment, only the cells change. V6 uses only the schema-level set; V7 adds the agent's own intake answers and the schema's dependency lists. On development data the intake cells alone add nothing; the gain comes from the learned event. V7 was designed after the registered results were known, tuned on the development cor-

Table 1: What each detector sees. Int.: intake answers; Com.: commitments and stated confidences; Rea.: reactions; Res.: resamples or verification queries; Sch.: the schema's dependency structure; Rul.: the simulator's rules and hidden-fact prior; Lab.: training labels. Oracle rows are not deployable.

Detector	Int.	Com.	Rea.	Res.	Sch.	Rul.	Lab.
SelfCheckGPT, semantic entropy	·	✓	·	✓	✓	·	·
CoVe	✓	✓	✓	✓	·	·	·
LLM judge	✓	✓	✓	·	·	·	·
Stated confidence	·	✓	·	·	·	·	✓
ctx-LR / ctx-LR+F	·	✓	+F	·	·	·	✓
Intake-LR+F	✓	✓	✓	·	·	·	✓
V6	·	✓	✓	·	✓	·	✓
V7	✓	✓	✓	·	✓	·	✓
$\bar{\eta}$ (oracle)	✓	✓	·	·	✓	✓	·
η_X, η_F (oracle)	✓	✓	✓	·	✓	✓	·
V6-session, LR-session+F (oracle)	·	✓	✓	·	✓	✓	✓

pora only (twelve variants, all logged), and frozen and registered (Amendment 6) before its first run on confirmatory data.

Supervised PGE classifiers. *ctx-LR* is an L_2 logistic regression ($C = 0.1$, fixed) on counts of confident commitments per (attribute, value) cell, $|H|$, the number of turns and mean confidence, with no reactions and no samples; *ctx-LR+F* adds counts per (attribute, value, reaction) cell. Neither sees the intake answers; "context-only" in the registered wording of H3 means no reactions and no samples. Both need the structured commitments that PGE elicits. Two feedback statistics (fraction of contradicted confident commitments, fraction of contradicted turns) are the simplest PGE detectors.

Baselines. SelfCheckGPT and semantic entropy on $k = 3$ resamples per turn at temperature 0.9 (exact-match clustering, adequate for categorical answers; for L_U computed on turns whose attribute is in the schema-level set above); Chain-of-Verification with the agent as its own verifier (Dhuliawala et al., 2024); mean stated (verbalized) confidence, sign chosen on the training split. Structure-based detectors from earlier work on reasoning graphs also read the reactions: a logistic regression on 14 summary features (confidence, reaction and degree statistics) of a graph with one node per commitment and edges for attribute dependencies; a two-layer GCN (Kipf and Welling, 2017); and five block-model graphon likelihoods (Lovász, 2012), of which we report the best on test, favouring the baseline. On L_U they score 0.41–0.66, between sampling and the PGE detectors, so we omit them from the tables.

6 Experimental Design

Environment. A simulated imaging clinic. Five coarse intake answers are shown to the agent; four hidden fields (days since treatment, allergy severity, kidney function, anxiety) are not. Each session asks for 6–12 of 12 attributes in dependency order. Six attributes can depend on a hidden field, but only for some intakes (a seventh, `transport_assistance`, depends on one in the schema but is always fixed by the intake). Ground truth is a deterministic function of intake and hidden fields; the hidden fields are independent draws from a fixed prior. The agent is a real LLM; only the patient is simulated. A second domain, a travel-booking assistant, has the same structure with different content: five intake answers (trip type, budget, travellers, duration, booking window), four undisclosed traveller facts (loyalty tier, mobility needs, dietary needs, seat preference), and twelve booking attributes, six of which can depend on an undisclosed fact. It was specified and registered before any of its data existed.

Reactions. In the main corpora the reaction to a commitment is its correctness bit flipped with probability $\varepsilon = 0.25$, absent for two attributes the patient never reacts to. In the *LLM-patient* corpus a second model (Llama-3.1-8B) role-plays the patient: it is given its own history but not the clinic's decision, one of three personas (attentive, trusting, anxious), and the agent's commitment as a hedged plain-language sentence, and replies in one or two sentences. A labeller model (in the first version, another call to the same 8B model) that sees only the sentence and the reply labels it as agreement, contradiction or neither. The agent reads the patient's verbatim replies. An *informed* variant also tells the patient the clinic's decision. A registered gate guards this corpus: a 100-session pilot runs first, and the full 600 sessions run only if contradictions are at least 1.5 times as frequent after wrong commitments as after correct ones.

Development and confirmation. Method development used two development corpora (Llama-3.3-70B, 600 sessions; Llama-3.1-8B, 200). A blind internal audit of these results found that the agent had been shown a corrupted feedback display, that resamples covered only five attributes, and that a feedback-free classifier nearly matched the posterior on L. Before generating new data we committed an analysis plan (Nosek et al., 2018): labels, detectors (V6 primary), every comparison, the statistics, and the wording each outcome licenses. Six amendments followed: three before any confirmatory data was seen (the supervised feedback increment, label-budget curves, the analyses of Section 7.3, H5's wording); the second domain, before any of its data existed; a replacement simulated patient, after the first failed its gate; and V7 with H7 and H8, after the registered results for four agents were known and before V7's first confirmatory run, when no detector had been run on the Llama-70B or travel corpora. The confirmatory corpora use a fresh seed, show the agent the raw reaction, draw three resamples on every turn, and cover five agents (Llama-3.3-70B, Llama-3.1-8B, Qwen2.5-72B, GPT-4o-mini, Mistral-Small-3.1-24B), 600 sessions each.

Table 2: Per-commitment check of Corollary 1 on commitments (any confidence) whose truth is user-dependent in that session. e_1, e_0: probability that some resample differs from the commitment, given that it is wrong / right. AUROC for predicting *that* commitment's error; the reaction column is on commitments that received one and equals $1-\varepsilon = 0.75$ by the simulator's design.

Agent	wrong	all agree	e_1	e_0	Disagreement	One reaction
Llama-70B	52.4%	91.4%	0.087	0.085	0.501	0.748
Llama-8B	39.7%	49.5%	0.544	0.478	0.555	0.746
Qwen-72B	43.1%	83.1%	0.189	0.154	0.517	0.744
GPT-4o-mini	42.9%	85.6%	0.183	0.115	0.535	0.746
Mistral-24B	40.6%	69.2%	0.344	0.283	0.534	0.746

Statistics. Splits are 70/30 by session for three split seeds; detectors are fit on the training split and score the test split once; AUROC is averaged over seeds. Differences use a paired bootstrap (2,000 resamples) clustered by session, since test sets of different seeds overlap. Pooled estimates average per-agent differences, with sessions resampled within agent. A difference is called significant when its 95% interval excludes zero; we do not correct for multiplicity, and intervals are conditional on the fitted detectors. Because the agents share sessions, we also resample sessions jointly across agents and report Holm-adjusted p-values (Table 4). The primary hypotheses are in Table 4, the per-agent comparisons on both labels in Appendix A, and every other registered comparison in the repository's analysis output.

Oracle-information analyses. Because the simulator's rules and hidden-field prior are known, we can compute three exact quantities. The *population risk* $\bar{\eta} = \sum_h P(h)\, L_U(C,h)$ is the probability that the session's commitments would be wrong for a random user with the same intake. $\eta_X = P(L_U = 1 \mid X, C)$ adds the reactions the agent was shown (all but the last); by Theorem 1 it bounds every detector computed from the agent's context and its resamples. η_F adds the last reaction and bounds every detector of commitments and reactions. The agent's policy does not involve the hidden facts, so its factors cancel and no agent model is needed. These are not deployable detectors; they locate the information. We also give V6 and ctx-LR(+F) the same oracle knowledge of which commitments are user-dependent in each session (V6-session, LR-session). (The registered plan calls $\bar{\eta}$, η_X and η_F eta0, etaX and etaF.)

7 Results

7.1 Sampling cannot see the user

Table 2 shows the mechanism. On commitments whose truth depends on undisclosed facts, resamples disagree about as often when the agent is right as when it is wrong: e_1 and e_0 differ by at most 0.07 on every agent, so by Corollary 1 the AUROC of disagreement is centred within half that of $\frac{1}{2}$. Qwen-72B and GPT-4o-mini mostly repeat themselves; Llama-8B and Mistral-24B disagree with themselves often, but equally often when right and when wrong. One reaction from our simulated user gives 0.75, as designed; the comparison shows how little a user's reaction needs to carry to beat resampling, not how much a real user's does. At the session level (Table 3), SelfCheckGPT and semantic entropy score 0.551 [0.524, 0.578] and 0.495 [0.481, 0.508] pooled over agents, both intervals inside the registered band of $[0.40, 0.60]$ (H1): sampling detectors are near chance on user-specific hallucination. Resampling sessions jointly across agents, which share them, gives 0.551 [0.520, 0.585] and 0.495 [0.480, 0.509], both still inside the band. H1 is a pooled claim: per agent SelfCheckGPT ranges over 0.492–0.610; the top value (Llama-8B) lies just outside the band. They are not near chance everywhere. On the composite label, where many errors are guesses about clinic rules that do vary across resamples, SelfCheckGPT reaches 0.645 [0.617, 0.672]. The failure is specific to facts the user never disclosed.

7.2 Detecting user-specific hallucination

Table 3 gives the confirmatory results and Table 4 the registered hypotheses, pooled over five agents.

Registered detectors. The user's implicit reactions add detectable signal beyond population base rates: +.070 [+.055, +.086]* to the posterior over its cell priors (H2; significant for 5 of 5 agents), and beyond the commitments themselves for the supervised detector (+.061 [+.041, +.080]*, H2b). Detectors on PGE observables beat both sampling detectors (H4: +.112 [+.081, +.143]* and +.169 [+.139, +.198]*; H4b: +.162 [+.126, +.195]* and +.219 [+.190, +.243]*). Against the registered supervised detectors the first posterior, V6, did not win: the comparison with the commitment-only classifier is null (H3: +.011 [−.021, +.043]; registered wording: "context alone matches PGE on this label"), and ctx-LR+F is ahead with the full training split (−.050 [−.076, −.021]*). V3, with a symmetric channel, is indistinguishable from V6 (+.0000 [−.004, +.003]).

The intake-aware posterior (Amendment 6). These results, and the oracle analysis of Section 7.3, located V6's weaknesses: its cells omit the intake, and its event is a proxy for the commitments the intake leaves to the user. V7 repairs both (Section 5) and reaches 0.825 [0.807, 0.843] AUROC pooled (Table 3). Conditioning on the intake improves the posterior (H7: +.162 [+.136, +.188]*), and given the same information the posterior beats the supervised detector (H8: +.089 [+.067, +.114]*; significant for 4 of 5 agents; "same information" means the same raw inputs, while V7 also encodes the schema's structure). V7 − ctx-LR+F is +.112 [+.090, +.139]* (H8′); registered without claims, V7 − SelfCheckGPT and V7 − semantic entropy are +.274 [+.244, +.306]* and +.330 [+.308,

Table 3: Session AUROC on the user-specific label L_U (mean of three splits; confirmatory corpora, 600 sessions per agent). †Added after the registered plan: ctx-LR+F plus the intake answers and commitment×intake cells; the comparator of H8 (Amendment 6). ‡Registered in Amendment 6 after the other results were known; designed on development data only. CoVe was run for the 70B agent only. §GPT-4o-mini reading the whole transcript with its reactions (zero-shot; exploratory). The composite label L is in the repository.

	Detector	Llama-70B	Llama-8B	Qwen-72B	GPT-4o-mini	Mistral-24B
Baselines	SelfCheckGPT	.492	.610	.559	.576	.520
	Semantic entropy	.497	.533	.485	.486	.474
	CoVe	??	–	–	–	–
	LLM judge§	??	.611	.647	.612	.627
PGE: commitments	Mean confidence	.550	.512	.522	.465	.454
	ctx-LR	.671	.686	.715	.635	.556
	V6−prior	.634	.591	.593	.575	.577
PGE: commitments + reactions	Contradicted confident	.613	.614	.628	.576	.637
	Contradicted turns	.563	.536	.579	.595	.624
	ctx-LR+F	.745	.725	.748	.668	.682
	Intake-LR+F†	.743	.782	.749	.717	.690
	PGE posterior (V6)	.695	.672	.650	.636	.666
	PGE posterior, intake-aware (V7)‡	**.902**	**.889**	**.810**	**.836**	**.690**
	L_U positive rate	39.5%	29.7%	39.0%	35.3%	40.3%

+.354]*, and on L V7 reaches 0.924 [0.910, 0.935] with V7 − intake-LR+F +.027 [+.011, +.042]*.

Stronger supervised detectors on the same raw inputs (exploratory) still trail V7: with C chosen by cross-validation by +.070 [+.049, +.094]*, gradient-boosted trees by +.058 [+.039, +.082]*. A logistic regression handed V7's own structure (cells conditioned on the intake answers each attribute depends on, schema-level attributes only, C by cross-validation) matches it (+.012 [−.005, +.033]): what wins is the structure, which commitments the intake leaves to the user, more than the estimator. The user's reactions carry part of it: scored without them, V7 loses +.083 [+.070, +.099]* (significant for 5 of 5 agents).

A zero-shot LLM judge that reads the whole transcript, reactions included (GPT-4o-mini; exploratory), reaches 0.624 [0.593, 0.656]: above SelfCheckGPT (+.058 [+.020, +.098]*) but far below V7 (+.182 [+.148, +.214]*, significant for 4 of 4 agents). Reading the reactions is not enough without the population structure.

Label budgets. Labels for user-specific hallucination require knowing the user's private facts, so small budgets are the realistic case (Figure 1; descriptive). With 25 labelled sessions V7 leads both supervised detectors on 5 of 5 agents (mean 0.639, against 0.604 for intake-LR+F and 0.585 for ctx-LR+F), and leads intake-LR+F on 3 of 5, 4 of 5 and 4 of 5 agents at 50, 100 and 200 labels (mean 0.772 against 0.717 at 200). The classifier handed V7's structure is as good at every budget (mean 0.648 at 25 labels and 0.776 at 200): with the structure given, the posterior's advantage is per-commitment risk, not session accuracy.

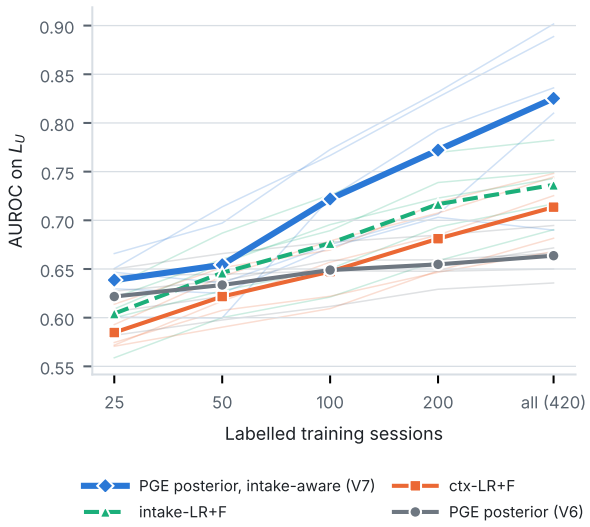


Figure 1: Test AUROC on L_U against the number of labelled training sessions (mean over agents; thin lines: individual agents; identical training subsets for every detector).

7.3 Where the information is

Table 5 and Figure 2 locate the signal. The population risk $\bar{\eta}$ alone is far above every sampling detector: much of L_U is visible in *which* values an agent commits to, given the intake. The user's reactions add $\eta_F - \bar{\eta}$ beyond it (H5). Almost all of that information reaches the agent's transcript ($\eta_F - \eta_X$ is +.001 [−.001, +.004]): reactions to earlier commitments are displayed later in the session, so a

Table 4: Registered hypotheses on L_U, pooled over five agents (stratified session bootstrap; *: 95% CI excludes 0). Holm: Holm-adjusted p over the difference tests, with sessions resampled jointly across agents, which share them. H7 and H8 are Amendment 6.

	Comparison	Estimate [95% CI]	Holm
H1	AUROC(SelfCheckGPT)	0.551 [0.524, 0.578]	–
H1	AUROC(semantic entropy)	0.495 [0.481, 0.508]	–
H2	V6 − V6−prior	+.070 [+.055, +.086]*	<.001
H2b	ctx-LR+F − ctx-LR	+.061 [+.041, +.080]*	<.001
H3	V6 − ctx-LR	+.011 [−.021, +.043]	.555
H4	V6 − SelfCheckGPT	+.112 [+.081, +.143]*	<.001
H4	V6 − semantic entropy	+.169 [+.139, +.198]*	<.001
H4b	ctx-LR+F − SelfCheckGPT	+.162 [+.126, +.195]*	<.001
H4b	ctx-LR+F − semantic entropy	+.219 [+.190, +.243]*	<.001
–	V6 − ctx-LR+F	−.050 [−.076, −.021]*	.012
H5	$\eta_F - \bar{\eta}$ (oracle)	+.083 [+.068, +.100]*	<.001
H6	V6-session − LR-session+F (oracle)	+.019 [+.006, +.037]*	.136
H7	V7 − V6	+.162 [+.136, +.188]*	<.001
H8	V7 − intake-LR+F	+.089 [+.067, +.114]*	<.001
H8′	V7 − ctx-LR+F	+.112 [+.090, +.139]*	<.001

Table 5: Oracle-information analysis on L_U (AUROC). $\bar{\eta}$: population risk of the commitments; η_X: Bayes given the conversation the agent saw (Theorem 1's bound for context-and-sample detectors); η_F: Bayes given all reactions. V6-session and LR-session+F are told which commitments are user-dependent in each session. Pooled differences are in Table 4.

Agent	$\bar{\eta}$	η_X	η_F	V6-sess.	LR-sess.+F
Llama-70B	.876	.942	.944	.913	.885
Llama-8B	.899	.952	.953	.904	.908
Qwen-72B	.854	.930	.932	.879	.851
GPT-4o-mini	.803	.907	.909	.837	.825
Mistral-24B	.781	.890	.891	.847	.814

detector reading the transcript could use them. Per-turn resampling cannot: agreement between samples ignores the reactions, and each resample is drawn before its own commitment's reaction. Given the same information (which commitments concern undisclosed facts), the PGE posterior beats the supervised detector (H6), by a small margin (+.019 [+.006, +.037]*) that does not survive resampling sessions jointly across agents (Holm $p = .136$), so we do not rely on it. Registered without a claim: V6-session − $\bar{\eta}$ is +.033 [+.013, +.053]*, and the reactions add +.032 to +.148 to LR-session across agents. Without that knowledge, V6 targets a schema-level set of attributes that is only a proxy for the label's support, which costs it 0.181–0.233 AUROC against V6-session, an order of magnitude more than the H6 margin: knowing *which* commitments concern undisclosed facts matters far more than how the evidence is combined. A deployable detector has to learn this from labels. A generic classifier mostly does not (intake-LR+F reaches 0.690–0.782, against 0.781–0.899 for the population risk computed with the rules). V7, which learns it as the posterior's label event, closes 76% of V6's gap to V6-session (mean 0.876) without oracle knowledge.

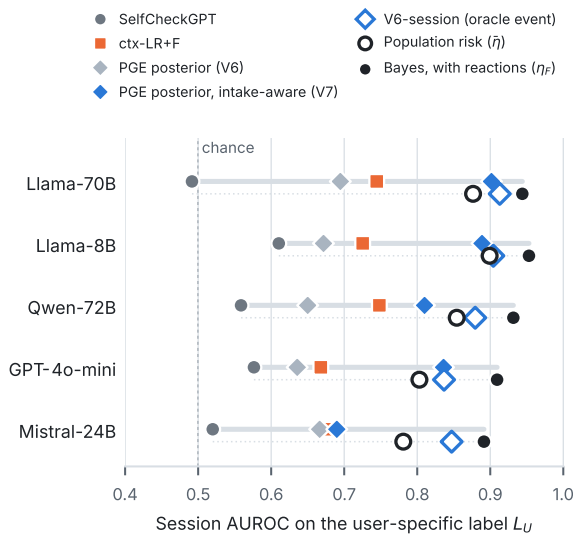


Figure 2: Where the signal is, on L_U. Upper row of each agent: deployable detectors. Sampling sits near chance; the intake-aware posterior V7 is the best of them. Lower row: oracle references (V6 told the user-dependent set, the population risk $\bar{\eta}$ and the Bayes posterior with reactions η_F).

Table 6: Second domain (travel booking), AUROC on L_U, 600 sessions per agent. No detector had been run on these corpora when V7 was registered.

Agent	SelfCheck	ctx-LR+F	intake-LR+F	V6	V7	$\bar{\eta}$	η_F
GPT-4o-mini	??	??	??	??	??	??	??
Llama-8B	.628	.825	.877	.796	**.904**	.944	.963

7.4 A second domain

The pattern transfers to travel booking (Table 6). For Llama-8B, SelfCheckGPT scores 0.628 and V7, run once on this corpus, 0.904: above V6 (+.108 [+.068, +.147]*), the registered supervised detector (+.081 [+.036, +.131]*) and SelfCheckGPT (+.279 [+.211, +.351]*), and level with intake-LR+F (+.028 [−.014, +.073]). The intake fixes more of the risk here: the population risk alone reaches 0.944, and the reactions add +.021 [+.002, +.041]* to it. [PENDING: GPT-4o-mini travel corpus (one session left) and the pooled within-domain tests]

7.5 Natural-language reactions

The first simulated patient failed its gate. Among commitments it replied to, it contradicted a fraction 0.83 of the wrong ones and 0.79 of the correct ones (lift 1.06; 100 sessions), against 0.75 and 0.25 for the noisy bit; the informed variant, told the clinic's decision, did little better (0.97 and 0.80, lift 1.21). Reading the replies shows why: the patient voiced doubt about facts it had not been given, and the labeller counted doubt as contradiction. As registered, neither was run at scale. A second version, registered be-

fore its data existed (Amendment 5), uses GPT-4o-mini for both roles, lets the patient object only to commitments that conflict with its listed facts, and labels a reply as a contradiction only if it states a conflict. [PENDING: v2 audit (P(-1|wrong), P(-1|right), lift) and, if it passes, detection V6 / V6-prior / ctx-LR / ctx-LR+F on both labels] A simulated user that does not track its own facts produces nearly uninformative reactions; the gate is what keeps such a corpus out of the results.

7.6 Choosing what to ask

The posterior's per-commitment risk q_t is what chooses the question, and no session-level classifier provides it. Over the confident commitments on the schema-level attributes, a set a deployed system can know, V7's q_t identifies the wrong ones with AUROC 0.892 [0.879, 0.906] (per agent 0.887–0.898) and calibration error 0.077, against 0.739 [0.713, 0.764] for the commitment's own reaction, 0.568 [0.557, 0.579] for resample disagreement and 0.629 [0.610, 0.648] for stated confidence (per split seed, session-clustered intervals; descriptive). On the subset whose truth is user-dependent in that session it reaches 0.797 [0.768, 0.825], against 0.752 [0.715, 0.787] for the reaction alone. The measured loop (70B agent) uses the first 120 test sessions of split seed 42 instead of the registered 180, a deviation forced by the API budget. The registered test failed. On the primary outcome, wrong confident user-dependent commitments per session (0.642 without questions), one question chosen by V6's risk did no better than one chosen at random ($-.008$ [$-.133$, $+.117$]), so the registered claim that choosing by posterior risk beats choosing at random is not supported; it did improve on rerunning without a question ($-.125$ [$-.242$, $+.000$]). The registered picker ranked commitments by V6 fit to the composite label, which counts rule errors. On that label two posterior-chosen questions match asking about every user-dependent attribute in hallucination rate ($-.017$ [$-.050$, $+.017$], with 2.00 instead of 4.29 questions per session) and leave fewer wrong confident commitments ($-.208$ [$-.408$, $-.017$]*); on L_U, asking about everything remains far better ($+.317$ [$+.233$, $+.400$]*). [PENDING: Amendment 7: the same loop with V7, fit to L_U, choosing the question (H9)]

7.7 Robustness to the user's behaviour

Our users react with a designed noise level. To see how much that matters, we regenerated the reactions seen by the detectors on the confirmatory trajectories, with the agents' trajectories fixed (Theorem 2's setting; exploratory; mean over agents of 5 draws). As the flip rate rises from 0.05 to 0.45, V7's mean AUROC on L_U falls from 0.961 to 0.669, faster than the Bayes bound (0.989 to 0.847), against 0.883 to 0.685 for intake-LR+F. With reactions to half or a quarter of the commitments, V7 scores 0.766 and 0.693 (intake-LR+F: 0.704 and 0.688). SelfCheckGPT, which reads no reactions, stays at 0.551. This measures the detectors' robustness only: the agents conditioned on the recorded reactions.

On the development corpora (protocol v2, label L), a "lazy" user who contradicts 60% of wrong commitments and never confirms correct ones breaks a posterior with a symmetric channel (0.425 for 70B); V6's general channel repairs it (0.857). Graph-based detectors and a cascade model over the dependency graph did not help (repository).

8 Limitations

Simulation. Our main users know whether each commitment is correct, with probability 0.75; real users know their facts, not the clinic's rules, which is what the LLM-simulated patient tests. The agents are real, but the patient is simulated: by a noisy correctness bit in the main corpora and by an LLM in one corpus. The oracle analyses rely on the simulator's known rules and prior, which a deployment does not have. *Two synthetic domains.* Both private-attribute domains are simulators we designed, with deterministic rules and independent hidden facts; real user populations have correlated, partially self-reported facts. *Post-hoc method.* V7 was designed after the registered results were known, tuned on development data only, and registered before its first confirmatory run; Llama-70B and the travel domain are the corpora on which no detector had been run when it was registered. *Labels.* Labels are programmatic and noise-free by construction; there is no human evaluation. *Supervision.* The posterior and the supervised baselines are fit on labelled training sessions; the posterior can run without labels when the channel is known, which we only test in development. *Untested detectors.* A second model that reads the transcript with its reactions is a feedback detector, not bounded by Theorem 1; we did not test one. Sampling detectors used three resamples (ten were registered as optional and not run), and with exact matching semantic entropy takes few values. We did not run hidden-state probes; Theorem 1 predicts they share the within-context limit, but they could exploit population risk as ctx-LR does. *Theory.* Proposition 1 is exact only under (A1)–(A2) with the true priors and channel, and the detector is a plug-in estimate; Theorem 2 covers reactions regenerated for the detector with the agent's trajectories fixed, not the protocol's own noise, because the agent conditions on the reactions it is shown.

9 Conclusion

When an agent invents a fact about its user, its own samples cannot tell which of the users sharing its context it is wrong about. Some of the risk is visible in what the agent commits to; the rest is visible only through the user's reactions. Making the agent state its assumptions as probabilistic commitments and recording the user's reactions makes both available, and a Bayes analysis in a simulator with known truth shows how much each is worth. An

intake-aware posterior turns them into session and per-commitment risk; the structure it encodes, which commitments the intake leaves to the user, is what separates the detectors we tested. [PENDING: one sentence on measured clarification]

Reproducibility. Code, all trajectories, the pre-registered plan with its six amendments and a log of their commit times, every analysis script, and a ledger of all runs including discarded variants are at [PENDING: anonymous repository link].

Use of AI tools. [PENDING: AI-assistance disclosure per ICAART policy, without names.]

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A Per-agent registered comparisons

Table 7 gives every registered difference per agent on both labels (point estimates; *: the paired session-clustered 95% CI excludes 0; intervals in the repository). H2: V6 − V6−prior; H2b: ctx-LR+F − ctx-LR; H3: V6 − ctx-LR; H4: V6 − SelfCheckGPT (SC) and semantic entropy (SE); H7: V7 − V6; H8: V7 − intake-LR+F.

Table 7: Registered differences per agent (AUROC).

Agent	H2	H2b	H3	H4 (SC)	H4 (SE)	V6−ctx-LR+F	H7	H8
User-specific label L_U (primary)								
Llama-70B	+.060*	+.070*	+.026	+.201*	+.197*	−.043	+.207*	+.160*
Llama-8B	+.079*	+.040*	−.016	+.060	+.139*	−.056*	+.217*	+.108*
Qwen-72B	+.057*	+.033	−.070*	+.086*	+.159*	−.103*	+.163*	+.060*
GPT-4o-mini	+.060*	+.034	+.005	+.058*	+.151*	−.029	+.198*	+.120*
Mistral-24B	+.090*	+.126*	+.115*	+.150*	+.197*	−.011	+.027	+.007
Pooled	+.070*	+.061*	+.011	+.112*	+.169*	−.050*	+.162*	+.089*
Composite label L (secondary)								
Llama-70B	+.042*	+.013	+.044*	+.340*	+.321*	+.030	+.056*	+.047*
Llama-8B	+.113*	+.067*	+.086*	+.186*	+.255*	+.018	+.089*	+.028
Qwen-72B	+.085*	+.028*	+.031	+.250*	+.352*	+.003	+.063*	+.034*
GPT-4o-mini	+.037*	+.005	+.042	+.111*	+.269*	+.037	+.069*	+.007
Mistral-24B	+.087*	+.026	−.005	+.135*	+.315*	−.030	+.086*	+.018
Pooled	+.073*	+.028*	+.041*	+.209*	+.306*	+.013	+.070*	+.027*